

# EMEFA A. APALOO

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[theCyberSecurityNotebook.substack.com](https://theCyberSecurityNotebook.substack.com) | [github.com/emmy-aa](https://github.com/emmy-aa)

## EDUCATION

**M.S., Computer Information Sciences** · Harrisburg University of Science & Technology (GPA 4.0) *Expected May 2028*  
**B.A., Computer Science · Minor: Business** · Hanover College *Aug 2021 – May 2025*

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Security & IAM:** SIEM (Wazuh), Splunk, IAM, MFA, HashiCorp Vault, Incident Response, Vulnerability Assessment (Nmap)  
**Network Security:** TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VLANs, QoS, VoIP, Multi-Site Network Design, Wireshark, Kali Linux  
**Scripting & Programming Languages:** Python, Bash, Java, SQL, JavaScript  
**Cloud & IaC:** Cloud Security, AWS, IaC, Packer, Vagrant, GitHub, Azure  
**Documentation & Tools:** Markdown, Microsoft Word/Excel, WordPress, Technical Documentation, PowerShell  
**Operating Systems:** Windows, Ubuntu Server, Kali Linux, Linux  
**Core Competencies:** SIEM, Incident Response, Network Security, Identity & Access Management, Threat Detection, Vulnerability Assessment, Log Analysis, Windows Administration, Linux Administration, Security Documentation

## SECURITY PROJECTS

**Home SOC Lab — SIEM Deployment & Network Monitoring.** *Independent Project.* *July 2026*

- Built a segmented multi-VM lab environment using VMware Workstation — Windows 11 endpoint, Ubuntu Server 24.04, and Kali Linux on a host-only network with NAT for controlled internet access
- Deployed and configured Wazuh SIEM on Ubuntu Server; installed and validated the Wazuh agent on the Windows 11 endpoint, confirming log ingestion and dashboard visibility
- Diagnosed and resolved infrastructure issues during deployment, including a DNS resolution failure and a downed network interface, through Netplan reconfiguration and resource tuning
- Configured Kali Linux as an attack workstation with Nmap, Wireshark, tcpdump, and Netcat to support traffic analysis and network reconnaissance practice

**Automated HashiCorp Vault Deployment via IaC** *Fall 2025*

- Engineered end-to-end infrastructure automation pipeline using Packer and Vagrant to build and provision Ubuntu Server environments — demonstrating hands-on proficiency in IaC principles and secure system configuration
- Deployed and configured HashiCorp Vault for secrets management: implemented secure credential storage, RBAC access control policies, and role-based authentication following industry best practices
- Managed full VM lifecycle including SSH-based remote access and provisioning validation; produced technical documentation for deployment reproducibility

**Enterprise Multi-Site Network Infrastructure Design** *Fall 2025*

- Architected enterprise-grade network for a 6-location hospitality company (400+ users) with segmented VLANs for PCI-DSS-compliant POS systems, guest Wi-Fi, and employee networks
- Designed redundant infrastructure with AD & RADIUS authentication, QoS traffic prioritization, and automated failover; authored a 3-year TCO analysis report.

## WORK EXPERIENCE

**Student IT Helpdesk Technician** · Hanover College — IT Department *Aug 2023 – May 2025 | Hanover, IN*

- Administered Active Directory user accounts — password resets, MFA configuration, and group membership management — directly supporting enterprise IAM operations
- Logged, triaged, and resolved 30+ monthly Tier 1 incidents via ticketing system; escalated complex issues to senior IT staff with full documentation and clear communication throughout
- Delivered Tier 1 technical support across hardware, software, and network issues via in-person, phone, and remote channels for students, faculty, and staff

**Website Development & Design Intern** · Madison Travel Company *Jun – Aug 2024*

- Diagnosed and resolved backend issues across 20+ plugins — including configuration failures and performance bottlenecks; applied security patches to close known vulnerability vectors
- Increased site traffic by 50% through SEO and content improvements; produced 3 internal style guides and documentation resources adopted for ongoing team use

## PUBLICATIONS & CERTIFICATIONS

**"A Rethink of Network Security Through Zero Trust Architecture"** — Contributing chapter author in *Examining Vulnerabilities and Adversarial Exploitation of AI and LLMs*.

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate, CompTIA Security+(In Progress)